

Emergency Codes

Introduction:

Hospital Emergency codes are codes often announced to alert professionals to various types of emergencies. Standardization of emergency codes all around the hospital promotes safety in the organization. It is meant to have immediate emergency response and gather expert assistance and mobilize them to manage the problem promptly.

Scope

This policy is intended for all healthcare professionals working at Royal Hospital. It provides guidance for a timely, well-coordinated response, ensuring optimum patients care.

Purpose

This document provides specific guidance regarding the emergency code system to all professionals working in the Royal Hospital during emergencies.

Emergency Codes:

The following codes are designed for emergency identification in the Royal Hospital:

Code Name		Code Number	Emergency Situation
Cardiac Arrest (Blue)		9555 7555 NHC	Heart or Respiration Stopping
*HERT (Green)		9444	Internal Emergency
Disaster (Orange)		9222	External Disaster
Fire Code (Red)		9777	Fire
Pink Code		9888	Infant and Child Abduction
PRRT		5571	Pediatric Rapid Response Team
CCOT (Purple)		5019 NURSE 5002 DR	Critical Care Outreach Team
Trauma		9333	Trauma Situation
White Code		9111	Combative Person



CARDIAC ARREST CODE (Adult/Child/Infant)

Definition:

Cardio-pulmonary Resuscitation (CPR): is an emergency procedure that combines chest compression often with artificial ventilation in an effort to manually preserve vital organ perfusion until further measures are taken to restore spontaneous blood circulation and breathing in a person who is in cardiac arrest.

Purpose:

1. To provide guidance for the planning and implementation of a high-quality cardio-pulmonary resuscitation service in the Royal Hospital.
2. Outline the procedure to respond to presumed cardiac arrest in a variety of settings
3. Describe the levels of resuscitation training required for healthcare professionals in the Royal Hospital.

Supportive information:

1. In the event of cardiac arrest dial the appropriate code 9555 (main campus) and 7555 (NHC) then press one to activate the code.
2. Announce ward/clinic (not initials) / level/ location (twice) and clearly state whether it is Adult or Pediatrics Code. Example; Cardiac arrest in Male Medical two/ level one/ adult patient (Twice)
3. Resuscitation efforts should be started immediately at the site of the arrest unless otherwise directed by the team leader.
4. The nearest crash cart can be summoned to the site.
5. The patient shall be moved to an appropriate area, if necessary, only after the patient's condition has been stabilized.

**** For detailed policy refer to CPR policy in Document Management System in the Royal Hospital Portal.**



HERT– INTERNAL EMERGENCY

Definition:

Hospital Emergency Response Team (HERT) is a hospital official who will initially visit the site of an internal incident or assess the situation arising out of an external incident and decide on the level of response required.

Purpose:

- 1- Communicate a significant disruption to normal operations in all or part of the hospital and initiate contingency plans in response to the specific emergent situation.
- 2- It is to protect patients and staff and ensure continued operations of the facility.

Supportive information:

- Report immediately to the site of the incident upon receiving the alert.
- Establish a command post in a safe location close to the scene of the incident.
- Rapidly assess the situation and determine (1) the level of activation required, (2) the need for the immediate evacuation of patients and staff, (3) if the Hospital Operations Centre should be notified
- Ensure that no patient care is affected by the incident.
- Remain at the site and be contactable till the Hospital Operations Centre takes charge (if the alert is escalated) or till stand-down (if the situation is under control and operations return to normal).

**** For detailed policy refer to Emergency Preparedness Plan in the Document Management System in the Royal Hospital Portal.**



DISASTER CODE – DISASTER

Definition:

A serious disruption of the functioning of a community or a society, resulting in widespread human, material, economic or environmental losses and impacts, which exceeds the ability of the affected community or society to cope using its own resources.

Purpose:

To set minimum standards required to ensure that a clear, consistent, and comprehensive approach to emergency management is undertaken across the Royal Hospital in case of emergency. This helps to reduce the catastrophic impact of the disaster particularly in vulnerable populations such as patient and their family.

Supportive information:

1. If the incident is likely to extend beyond the local area and may require external resources. In such a situation, Hospital Emergency Response Team (HERT) will instruct the switchboard to activate the Full Disaster Code 9222
2. Once Code is activated, all members of the Hospital Operations Centre (HOC) shall report immediately to the HOC location then, they will direct and control hospital operations in response to a disaster incident.

**** For detailed policy refer to the Emergency Preparedness Plan in the Document Management System in the Royal Hospital Portal.**



FIRE CODE- FIRE

Definition:

Fire Code is an alert system initiated in event of any confirmed fire incident.

Purpose:

To communicate risk and to mobilize a response to protect patients, families, visitors, staff, physicians, and property in case of a fire incident.

Supportive information:

Fire code should be immediately initiated if any confirmed fire incident. The alert action plan includes the following steps:

- Do not panic, Shout “FIRE” and summon the assistance of others in your area.
- Raise the alarm by breaking the glass at the nearest fire alarm call point.
- Dial the fire emergency code 9777, the staff shall record the location, the name of the caller, and details of the fire.
- If it is safe to do so, attempt to extinguish the fire.
- If the fire is out of control, prepare to evacuate. Follow the department's evacuation plan.
- Attempt to close all doors and switch off electrical items as you leave.
- Follow the instructions of the person in charge of your area.
- Alert all staff and customers if any, and evacuate from the area of immediate danger
- Close doors and windows in your area. Ensure that hallway doors are closed. Prepare for evacuation.

** For detailed policy refer fire code policy in the Document Management System in the Royal Hospital Portal.



PINK CODE – INFANT OR CHILD ABDUCTION

Definition:

An alarm system is initiated in response to an event of an infant or a child abduction.

Purpose:

A Pink Code should be initiated when an infant or child is missing or has been abducted up to the age of five years who are at the Royal Hospital Premises.

Supportive information:

The alert action plan includes the following steps:

1. Search of the entire ward/department/area must be conducted immediately, being careful not to remove or disturb anything which may be of future evidential value or to alarm other patients/parents/ care providers.
2. Escalating concerns to other teams and departments.
3. The nurse in charge after confirmation of abduction has to activate pink code 9888
4. Securing entrance and exits by lockdown plan (a security measure is taken during the emergency to prevent from leaving or entering a building.
5. Supporting the family of the child.
6. Liaison with the Public Relation Officer (PRO)
7. Response: proven abduction of a newborn/infant/child is a criminal act and the Royal Oman Police (ROP) will have overall authority for taking responsibility for the investigation and management of the incident.
8. Confidentiality is paramount no media reports will be made to the press without liaison with the police. The Royal Hospital Management Team must be made aware of the incident and all media requests for information must be directed through this team only. Staff must not provide any comment or information.

**** For detailed policy refer to infant/child abduction policy in the Document Management System in the Royal Hospital Portal**



PEDIATRIC RAPID RESPONSE TEAM

Definition:

Teams comprise a variety of healthcare providers with advanced skills intended to identify critically ill patients and mobilize a clinical response to prevent or reverse the pediatric patient deterioration.

Purpose:

To improve pediatric patient outcomes by supporting ward nursing staff in the detection, early intervention, and communication for pediatric patients who demonstrate acute changes and /or are progressively deteriorating with the utilization of the PEWS tool.

Supportive information:

Indications for calling the Rapid Response Team include:

1. Initially the nursing staff must do all they can to reduce the score (e.g. oxygenation, positioning, and medication).
2. If a patient scores from 1 to 4 this indicates the need for close and frequent observation of the patient and to inform the nurse in charge.
3. If the score reaches more or equal to 5, call the ward registrar, and record vital signs every 30 minutes
4. After 60 minutes, if the patient's PEWS remains more or equal to 5 the call rapid response team.

**** For detailed policy refer to Pediatric Rapid Response Team in the Document Management System in the Royal Hospital Portal.**



CCOT- CRITICAL CARE OUTREACH TEAM

Definition:

The **Critical Care Outreach Team (CCOT)** is a mobile ICU service that offers intensive care skills to patients with, or at risk of critical illness receiving care in locations outside the intensive care.

Purpose:

Communicate that immediate response and assessment are needed for an adult patient whose medical condition is declining. This team provides additional support to the bedside nurse prior to the cessation of cardiac or respiratory function. Calling the CCOT serves as a second pair of eyes and support for the patient's nurse.

Supportive information:

All patients should have routine bedside observations recorded regarding physiological parameters (MEWS). The higher the score the more abnormal the vital signs are.

Initially, the nursing staff must do all they can to reduce the score (e.g. oxygenation, positioning).

- If a patient scores 2 in any category this indicates the need for close and frequent observation of the patient.
- If the score reaches 4 or more the critical care outreach nurse must be called to assess the patient and doctor informed of the deterioration

**** For detailed policy refer to the use of the Modified Early Warning Score (MEWS) Document Management System in the Royal Hospital Portal**



TRAUMA CODE: TRAUMA

Purpose:

Communicate the occurrence of a Trauma case arrived in the emergency department.

Definition:

Trauma Code is initiated in case a trauma case has arrived at the Emergency Department.

Supportive information:

1. The criteria for activation of the trauma code must be clearly posted in the resuscitation room.
2. The trauma code may be activated prior to patient arrival based on the EMS communication.
3. To activate the trauma code dial 9333, then press one, and state clearly, pediatric trauma in the pediatric emergency department (three times and then close)

**** For detailed policy refer Trauma policy in the Document Management System in the Royal Hospital Portal.**



WHITE CODE

Definition:

Code White is the alert initiated to manage patients, visitors, or members of the public who exhibit abusive, aggressive, or violent behavior, which is directed at patients, hospital staff, or hospital property.

Purpose:

To summon the immediate presence of the administration and security staff when warranted to protect patients, families, visitors, health care providers, and property in the event of a combative person.

Supportive information:

To activate Code White, dial 9111 and follow the next steps:

- a. When you call 9111, a message will appear to press 1, to confirm that you want to report a violence case.
- b. Once activated, the staff sends a voice message that includes the exact location of the incident, the nature of the incident, your name, and designation.
- c. End the call. The message will reach the code white team which will respond promptly. Code white team consists of the following members: Security In-charge (5144), PSO (5021), and Duty Nursing Officer (5009).

**** For detailed policy refer to Code White Policy in Document Management System in the Royal Hospital Portal.**

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